

KIAN RAVAEI

**THREE
NOTHINGS**

for solo violoncello

ÆI edition

KIAN RAVAEI

**THREE
NOTHINGS**

for solo violoncello

(2025)

I. After Death	1
II. Sisyphus	2
III. Before Birth (Bardo)	5

ÆI edition

Commissioned by Sarah Rommel.

PROGRAM NOTE

In this piece, I make a musical effort to understand the two periods of non-existence—before and after life—as well as the in-between we call existence, so momentary and Sisyphean that it too may be called a “nothing.”

—Kian Ravaei

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

My sincerest thanks to cellists Boubacar Diallo, Robert Feifan Hurley, Dylan Kinneavy, and Sarah Rommel, whose advice was essential in the creation of this work.

duration ca. 9'

to Sarah Rommel

THREE NOTHINGS

for solo cello

Kian Ravaei

(2025)

I. After Death

Grieving, with much rubato ♩ = 50–58

p cresc. and dim. ad lib. (sempre)

4 *rit. a tempo, aching*

7 *mf rit. a tempo, somber pp*

10 *p mf rit.*

13 *f a tempo, feeling new strength*

16 *ten. rit. a tempo, tearful ff > mf > p*

19 *rit. al fine pp*

II. Sisyphus

Lumbering footsteps $\text{♩} = 54$ ($\text{♩} = 108$)

f heavy

10

20

29

Freely (sul A)

sf *p* ethereal

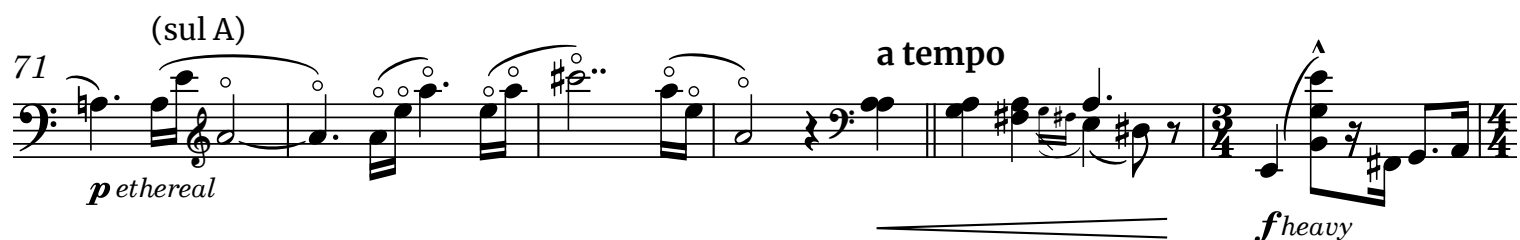
36 a tempo

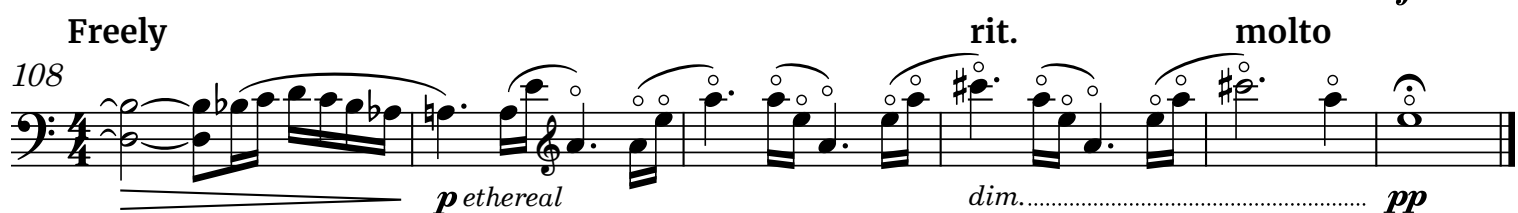
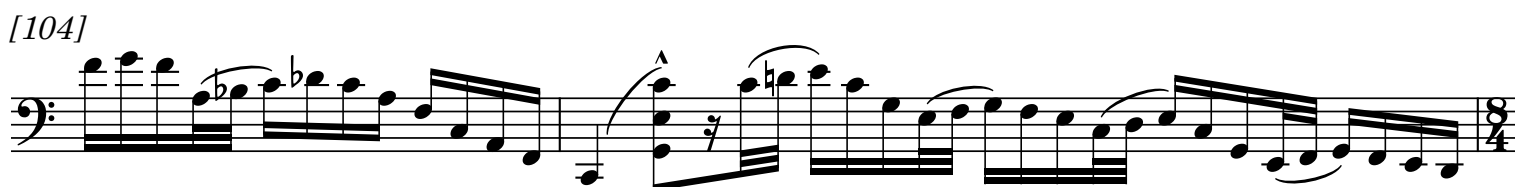
f heavy

43

49

55





III. Before Birth (Bardo)

As fast as possible $\text{♩} = 144-152$ (ben misurato)

musical score for a piece titled "III. Before Birth (Bardo)". The tempo is marked "As fast as possible" with a quarter note equal to 144-152 beats per minute, and the style is "ben misurato". The score is written in bass clef with a 2/2 time signature. It consists of 48 measures, divided into systems of four measures each. The key signature is B-flat major (two flats). The score includes dynamic markings: *mf* (measures 1-10) and *f* (measures 31-48). There are also performance instructions: a breath mark (V) at the start of measure 1, and a double bar line with repeat dots at the end of measure 16. Measure numbers 6, 11, 16, 21, 26, 31, 36, 41, and 46 are indicated at the start of their respective systems. Measure numbers 17 and 33 are enclosed in boxes above the staff. The notation features many beamed eighth notes and sixteenth notes, suggesting a fast, rhythmic passage.

51

56

61

rit.

p *ff* *p*

66 a tempo

mf

71

76

81

82

86

91

96

ff

The musical score is written for a bass clef instrument. It consists of measures 51 through 96. The key signature has one flat (B-flat). The time signature is not explicitly shown but appears to be 4/4. The score includes various musical notations such as notes, rests, and dynamic markings (p, ff, mf). Measure 66 is marked 'a tempo'. Measure 82 is highlighted with a box. The score ends with a double bar line and a repeat sign.

101 102

f

106

111

116

121

126

ff *p* *ff* *p*

6 *6*

131 *rit.* 135 *a tempo*

ff *p* *mf*

136

141

146 (off the string)

ff

